

VTS HOMEPAGE

Design & Content Revision Guide

For redesign of the VTS homepage mockup

VTS Navy #254771	Dark Navy #172E4C	VTS Red #B33A3A	Pale Blue #EDF4F8	Off White #FAFAF7	Charcoal #30343B
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Approved direction: clean, credible, modern nonprofit design with strong workforce-training energy. Use authentic VTS photography, disciplined navy-and-red branding, readable typography, and fewer competing elements.

Core brand direction: Professional • Trustworthy • Warm • Military-connected without looking militarized

1. Global Design System

Color palette

Purpose	Color	Hex	Approved use
Primary	VTN Navy	#254771	Header, headings, primary buttons, icons, footer
Dark background	Dark Navy	#172E4C	Hero overlays, donation section, footer
Accent	VTN Red	#B33A3A	Donate button, labels, active states, thin rules, selected highlights
Soft background	Pale Blue	#EDF4F8	Alternating sections, icon circles, review area
Main background	Warm Off-White	#FAFAF7	Page background and calm content areas
Body text	Charcoal	#30343B	Paragraphs and secondary copy
Borders	Light Gray	#DDE3E8	Cards, dividers, fields
White	White	#FFFFFF	Cards, text on dark backgrounds

Color rules

- Use roughly 70% white/off-white, 20% navy/pale blue, and 10% red accent.
- Use red deliberately: donate button, small section labels, active states, date blocks, thin lines, important callouts.
- Do not use red for long paragraphs, large background fields, every button, or every card title.
- Do not add gold as a major website color. Review stars may remain gold if needed for familiarity.

Typography

- Headings: Montserrat Bold or ExtraBold.
- Body copy, navigation, buttons, and form labels: Inter Regular/Medium/Semibold.
- Desktop sizes: hero 58–64 px; section headings 40–44 px; card headings 22–26 px; body 17–18 px; navigation 15–16 px; buttons 16 px.
- Mobile sizes: hero 38–42 px; section headings 30–34 px; body 17 px.
- Avoid military stencil fonts, condensed display fonts, all-caps paragraphs, and repeated dramatic line breaks.

Buttons

- Primary: navy background with white text.
- Secondary: white or transparent background with navy border and navy text.

- High-attention/Donate: red background with white text.
- Use the same height, padding, corner radius, and hover behavior across the site.
- Use specific action labels such as “View Upcoming Classes” instead of vague “Learn More” buttons.

Cards and imagery

- Use white cards with a thin light-gray border, subtle shadow, 12–16 px corner radius, and equal heights.
- Use real VTS classroom, training, outreach, instructor, and participant photography.
- Avoid generic stock military images, excessive patriotic graphics, camouflage, flag overlays, and random icon styles.
- Keep one consistent photo treatment and one consistent card system throughout the homepage.

2. Announcement Bar & Header

Purpose: Give visitors fast access to classes, programs, and donations without stacking multiple interruptions.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
• One slim announcement bar • White main navigation • VTS logo • One Donate button • One Upcoming Classes button	• Simplify menu to About Programs Events Success Resources Contact • Use navy text and a red Donate button • Keep announcement bar to approximately 40 px high	• Automatic social popup on arrival • Multiple stacked banners • Oversized social icons in the header

Approved design direction

- Announcement bar copy should be brief and link directly to upcoming classes.
- Keep the main navigation clean and calm, with Donate as the strongest visual action.
- Move social links to the footer or a delayed, nonintrusive placement.

3. Hero Section

Purpose: State the VTS mission immediately and create a strong first impression.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
• One authentic VTS photo • Large direct headline • Two clear calls to action • Short supporting paragraph	• Use “From Service to Industry.” as the headline • Use a dark navy gradient overlay behind text • Primary button: View Upcoming Classes • Secondary button: Explore VTS Programs	• Generic stock military images • Multiple competing badges in the hero • Decorative shapes that distract from the photo and message

Approved design direction

- Headline in Montserrat ExtraBold at approximately 58–64 px desktop.
- Supporting text should be 18–20 px and no more than two or three short lines.
- Keep badges and trust marks in a separate trust row below the hero.

4. Impact Statistics

Purpose: Show verified organizational impact without clutter.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
• Four-column desktop statistic row • Large numbers • Short supporting labels	• Use verified VTS impact measures • Use navy numbers with a thin red rule or accent • Stack into a 2x2 grid on mobile	• Counters that load as zero • Decorative icons for every statistic • Unverified or vague totals

Approved design direction

- Recommended statistics: 15,000+ military community members served; 11,000+ OSHA safety cards; 7,000+ Lean Six Sigma certifications; Serving since 2014.
- The real number must be present in the page code before any animation begins.
- Numbers around 46–52 px; labels around 16–17 px.

5. Coursera Feature

Purpose: Highlight one of VTS's largest education programs using accurate, verified data.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
• Prominent placement near the top • Split image-and-content layout • One application button • Three clean statistic cards	• Use the exact phrase "Coursera course enrollments" • Show 193,780 all-time enrollments • Show 60,639 enrollments in 2025 • Show 12 months of access for approved participants	• 75,000 licenses issued • 20,000 active each year • Calling enrollments people, licenses, graduates, or certificates • Oversized FREE badge

Approved design direction

- Background: pale blue.
- Heading and body: navy/charcoal; small red section label.
- Stat card 1: 193,780 — All-time Coursera course enrollments.
- Stat card 2: 60,639 — Coursera course enrollments in 2025.
- Stat card 3: 12 months — Access for approved participants.
- Small clarification may state that totals include enrollments from new and returning learners.

6. Programs

Purpose: Present VTS services clearly without mixing in TCCA paid courses.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- Uniform program cards - Short descriptions - Delivery format - Eligibility/cost line - One consistent link	- Group cards into Certifications & Training and Career & Education - Use navy headings, red top rule, pale-blue icon circles - Use three cards per row desktop, two tablet, one mobile	- Paid TCCA OSHA 30 and LSSGB courses - Different color theme for every card - Random card heights - Long program descriptions

Approved design direction

- Suggested VTS cards: OSHA 10 Safety Training; Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt; Accident Investigation & Recordkeeping; Warehouse Safety Plans & IIPP; Career Coaching & Resume Support; Free Coursera Access.
- Use one clear action per card: View Schedule, View Program, or Apply.

7. About VTS

Purpose: Introduce VTS as an organization before focusing on any one person.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- Real VTS photography - Since 2014 - All-volunteer identity 501(c)(3) status - One About button	- Use two-column photo/text layout - Add three compact trust points: 100% All-Volunteer; 501(c)(3), EIN 47-1391543; 15,000+ served	"No overhead games" language - Repeated award badges - Founder-centered homepage copy - Stacked decorative date treatment

Approved design direction

- White background with navy heading and red accent line.
- Use one large photo and one smaller overlapping photo.
- Keep the text short and send visitors to the full About page for history and leadership.

8. Who VTS Serves

Purpose: State public online eligibility clearly and prevent unnecessary inquiries.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- Five eligibility items - Simple checkmarks - Clear heading	Use only: Veterans; Active-Duty Service Members; Reservists; National Guard Members; Current Military Spouses	- Base staff - Dependents - Contractors "Others may qualify" wording - Any eligibility footnote or exception language

Approved design direction

- Use five checkmarks or small cards on a pale-blue background.
- Do not add a small note about on-base partnerships or program exceptions.
- The public website should be intentionally narrow so visitors self-sort correctly.

9. Upcoming Classes & Events

Purpose: Show the next opportunities without allowing the homepage to become stale or crowded.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- Three upcoming events maximum - Date block - Program title - Online/in-person format - Clear details button	- Pull automatically from the event system/API - Use red date blocks and navy headings - Use one button to the full events page	- Manual dates that can expire - Oversized featured-program panel - TCCA paid courses displayed as VTS programs - Four or more homepage events

Approved design direction

- White background with clean event rows or cards.
- Homepage feed should display only VTS no-cost programs, workshops, career support, and veteran-resource events.
- The calendar must update automatically wherever the feed/API is used.

10. Instructors

Purpose: Build confidence in training quality without turning the homepage into a biography page.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- Professional photos - Names and roles - Military affiliation when relevant - One short description - Link to full instructor page	- Show three instructor cards maximum - Use equal photo sizing and equal card heights - Use heading “Experienced Instructors. Practical Training.”	- Full biographies - Military emojis - Service dates unless essential - Headline implying every instructor served

Approved design direction

- White cards with pale-blue photo backgrounds.
- Names in navy; role line in red.
- Button: Meet Our Instructors.

11. Google Reviews

Purpose: Add third-party social proof while keeping control over which reviews appear.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- Three Google reviews chosen by VTS - Google icon - Public display name - Star rating - Link to Google	- Use heading “What People Are Saying” - Choose reviews that are specific, credible, and representative - Use button “Read More Reviews on Google”	- The word “Selected” in the heading - Long review walls - Automatic random feed as the only control - Private participant details

Approved design direction

- Pale-blue background with three white review cards.
- Use red quote accents, navy names, charcoal review text, and familiar gold stars.
- The reviews may be manually curated or drawn from a controlled feed.

12. Donation Section

Purpose: Create one strong giving invitation that links to the full donation page.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- Strong VTS photo - Short mission-based appeal - Red Donate button - Optional monthly donor button	- Use dark navy full-width section - Use \$10 monthly, \$250, and \$500 as brief examples - Link to the complete Zeffy donation page	- Embedded full Zeffy form on homepage "Zero overhead" "Every dollar goes directly to programs" - Unverified exact sponsorship claims - Volunteer recruitment inside donation block

Approved design direction

- White heading and copy on dark navy.
- Primary Donate button in VTS red; secondary monthly giving button outlined in white.
- Keep the section concise and emotionally strong.

13. Current Donor Spotlight

Purpose: Recognize one current supporter while sending visitors to the full donor page.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- One current spotlight donor - Logo - One strong photo - Short paragraph - Full spotlight link	- Use heading "Current Donor Spotlight" - Current donor: CrossCountry Mortgage - Donation amount may be shown if VTS wants it public and consistent	"Featured Donor" wording - Recent spotlight grids - Honor wall on homepage - Long donor histories - Multiple repeated donor buttons

Approved design direction

- Keep this as one polished card or split image/text feature.
- Use consistent logo sizing.
- Button: Read Full Spotlight or View Donors and Sponsors.

14. Job Success Board Preview

Purpose: Celebrate reported career outcomes while protecting privacy and avoiding a database-style homepage block.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
• Three to five recent success entries • First name and last initial • Branch/rank • Career field • Starting salary • Link to full board	• Use exact uniform format, for example: John D. USMC E-4 Safety \$65,000 • Use one clean preview card system • Keep the full board on its dedicated page	• Employer names • Full last names • MOS • Filters and pagination on homepage • Unverified totals • Confetti or star-heavy design

Approved design direction

- Off-white or pale-blue background with white cards.
- Names in navy; salary in red.
- Use heading “Job Success Board” and button “View the Full Job Success Board.”

15. Volunteer Section

Purpose: Invite participation without overwhelming visitors.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- One real volunteer/classroom image - Short invitation - One volunteer button	- Use a smaller pale-blue section - Use heading “Volunteer With VTS” - Keep copy to two or three lines	- Embedded volunteer application - Long role list - Placement inside the donation section

Approved design direction

- Use one navy button: Explore Volunteer Opportunities.
- Keep the full role descriptions and application process on the dedicated page.

16. Newsletter & Footer

Purpose: Close the homepage cleanly and provide clear pathways to key pages.

KEEP	CHANGE	REMOVE
- Simple newsletter signup - Footer logo and mission - EIN - Programs and organization links - Contact information - Social icons	- Newsletter fields: First Name and Email - Use red Subscribe button - Organize footer into four columns - Use red hover accents	- Arrival popup - Oversized social icons - Repeated badges - Repeated donation appeals - Mockup/client-review text

Approved design direction

- Footer background: dark navy.
- Use white main text and muted pale-blue secondary text.
- Include Privacy Policy, Terms, and Accessibility in the bottom row.
- Include © Veterans Transition Support. All rights reserved.

17. Final Homepage Order

1. Announcement bar and header
2. Hero
3. Trust row / impact statistics
4. Coursera feature
5. Programs
6. About VTS

- 7. Who VTS Serves
- 8. Upcoming Classes & Events
- 9. Instructors
- 10. Google Reviews
- 11. Donation
- 12. Current Donor Spotlight
- 13. Job Success Board preview
- 14. Volunteer
- 15. Newsletter
- 16. Footer

18. Non-Negotiable Content & Design Rules

- Keep VTS and TCCA clearly separated. Paid TCCA courses must not appear as VTS programs.
- Public online eligibility must list only Veterans, Active Duty, Reservists, National Guard, and current Military Spouses.
- Do not mention base staff, dependents, contractors, or possible exceptions on the public homepage.
- Coursera statistics must be labeled as course enrollments: 193,780 all time and 60,639 in 2025.
- Do not call Coursera enrollments licenses, people served, graduates, or certificates earned.
- Use the VTS navy-and-red brand consistently; red is an accent, not the dominant page color.
- Use authentic VTS photography whenever available.
- No zero-loading statistic counters, placeholder data, mockup labels, or sample records may remain in production.
- No employer names or full last names on the Job Success Board.
- No claims such as zero overhead, every dollar goes directly to programs, or 100% of donations fund programs.

19. Designer Handoff Checklist

- ☐ Apply approved color palette and type system globally.
- ☐ Create one reusable card component, one button system, and one section-label style.
- ☐ Remove popup, placeholder content, duplicate calls to action, and unnecessary badges.
- ☐ Confirm all statistics and public eligibility language exactly match this guide.
- ☐ Connect events to an automatically updating source/API.
- ☐ Build Google reviews as a controlled three-review display.
- ☐ Link donation CTA to the full Zeffy donation page; do not embed the full form.
- ☐ Keep Current Donor Spotlight to one donor.
- ☐ Limit Job Success Board to a homepage preview and link to the full board.
- ☐ Test desktop, tablet, and mobile layouts for readability, spacing, and button consistency.
- ☐ Confirm WCAG-conscious contrast and minimum readable font sizes.
- ☐ Remove all “mockup,” “client review,” and developer-only text before launch.

Final visual goal: a clean civic nonprofit website with modern workforce-training energy — credible, warm, disciplined, and unmistakably VTS.